

INTERVAL QUALITY PROGRESSION

The complete spectrum of interval qualities — from diminished to augmented — and how they relate to each other through inversion.

QUALITY LADDERS

FOR 2NDS · 3RDS · 6THS · 7THS

Augmented (aug)

RAISED ABOVE MAJOR

↑ raise 1 semitone

Major (M) BASELINE

THE DEFAULT QUALITY

Minor (m)

LOWERED 1 SEMITONE

↓ lower 1 semitone

Diminished (dim)

LOWERED 2 SEMITONES

↓ lower 1 semitone again

FOR 4THS · 5THS · UNISON · OCTAVE

Augmented (aug)

RAISED ABOVE PERFECT

↑ raise 1 semitone

Perfect (P) BASELINE

NO MAJOR/MINOR — SKIP

Diminished (dim)

LOWERED 1 SEMITONE

↓ lower 1 semitone

Note: No "Minor Perfect" — Perfect intervals have no minor quality. Lowering a Perfect creates Diminished directly.

THE TRITONE — THE CROSSOVER POINT

The tritone sits exactly at 6 half steps — the halfway point of the octave. It has two names that mean the same thing:

Augmented 4th (Aug4) = Diminished 5th (dim5) = 6 half steps = C .. F[♯] / G[♭]

INVERSION PAIRS — ORIGINAL + INVERSION = 9

Flip any interval upside down — the numbers add to 9, the quality flips (Major .. Minor, Aug .. Dim, Perfect stays Perfect)

2 + 7

= 9

m2 .. M7
M2 .. m7

3 + 6

= 9

m3 .. M6
M3 .. m6

4 + 5

= 9

P4 .. P5
(both Perfect)

1 + 8

= 9

P1 .. P8
Unison .. Octave